INDICATOR 15.3.5

SDG 15 Life on Land Evidence Report 2025

Mariano Marcos State University · THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027

Data year 2025 · Draft for validation · prepared 6 November 2026

SDG assigned	SDG 15 · Life on Land	**Data year**	2025
Team Members	[Name, position]	**Date prepared**	6 November 2026

1 · Sites and platforms explored

Every site and office where evidence for this indicator was found, and where nothing was found. A list of sites is not evidence; it only shows where the team has looked.

#	Site or office	URL or location	What was found
1	MMSU News	https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news	5 items for 15.3.5: MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and Pasuquin LGU Sign Agreement to Conserve a Coastal Forest; MMSU, Rotary Club and Badoc LGU Restore a Typhoon-Damaged Mangrove Stand; MMSU Plants 250 Mangrove Propagules in Currimao on World Environment Day and 2 more
2	The Manila Times	https://www.manilatimes.net	1 item for 15.3.5: MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and Pasuquin LGU Sign Agreement to Conserve a Coastal Forest
3	Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking	Internal SDG 15 report (2025)	2 items for 15.3.5: MMSU and DENR Region 1 Strengthen Partnership for Mangrove Conservation; Indigenous Food Plant Foodscapes Established with Vintar and San Nicolas Partners
4	MMSU Extension Directorate	https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news	1 item for 15.3.5: Indigenous Food Plant Foodscapes Established with Vintar and San Nicolas Partners
5	DOST-PCAARRD	https://www.pcaarrd.dost.gov.ph	1 item for 15.3.5: Mangrove Nature-based Solutions Project Runs from 2024 to 2026
6	MMSU SDG 15 and policy resource pages	https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources	1 item for 15.3.5: MMSU Expert Serves on the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park Technical Working Group

Not yet explored

Sources the team should still search. Suggestions are listed; add your own.

#	Source to search	Assigned to
1	College and department websites and social media pages	
2	Office records (Registrar, HR, Planning, Procurement, Physical Plant, Student Affairs)	
3	Board of Regents resolutions and memoranda	
4	Extension and Research Directorate pages and accomplishment reports	
5	Agreements (MOA, MOU) with LGUs, agencies, NGOs and industry	
6	News outlets and partner websites (DENR, LGUs, DOST, PhilRice)	
7	[Add a source]	

2 · Indicators to report

SDG 15 · Life on Land · data year 2025

Indicator	Description
15.3.5	Collaboration for shared land ecosystems. Collaborate with the local community to maintain shared land ecosystems.

3 · Optional: what other universities submit

What other universities claim for this indicator, and where MMSU might hold the same kind of evidence.

University	What it submits (indicator and type of evidence)	What to look for at MMSU
Caraga State University	15.3.5: agreements with DENR and barangays	MMSU 2025 agreements and plantings: Pasuquin MOA, Badoc, Currimao, and the DENR MOU.

[Add the THE edition and URL for each result before using this page.]

4 · Evidence by indicator

SDG 15.3.5 · Collaboration for shared land ecosystems

Collaborate with the local community to maintain shared land ecosystems.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

Submission pick: Pasuquin agreement, https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-ties-up-with-toyota-and-denr-for-coastal-preservation-in-pasuquin-town

MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and Pasuquin LGU Sign Agreement to Conserve a Coastal Forest



Signing of the memorandum of agreement among MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and LGU-Pasuquin, 29 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



MMSU, TMP Foundation, DENR and LGU-Pasuquin officials at the agreement signing, 29 November 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

On November 29, 2025, Mariano Marcos State University, the Toyota Motor Philippines Foundation (TMPF), the Department of Environment and Natural Resources and the Local Government Unit of Pasuquin formalized through a memorandum of agreement a partnership to strengthen coastal forest conservation in Barangay Davila, Pasuquin, Ilocos Norte. The agreement was signed by MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr. with TMPF leadership, Toyota Motor Philippines and Toyota Ilocos Norte executives, DENR-CENRO Bangui Ecosystem Management Specialist Justine Rose Teneza, and Sangguniang Bayan Member Romel Ranay for LGU-Pasuquin.

A mangrove planting followed the signing at the degraded two-hectare National Greening Program site in Barangay Davila: about 110 volunteers, including members of the MMSU College of Industrial Technology, DENR-CENRO Bangui, the Municipal Environment and Natural Resources Office and residents, planted 1,750 seedlings, and the partners will plant 3,500 seedlings of the native mangrove species lapis-lapis and arinaya over two years. TMPF President Jose Maria Aligada described the partnership as shared stewardship to restore native mangrove species, rehabilitate coastal systems and boost community resilience to climate-related hazards. Former MMSU College of Industrial Technology Dean Cesario Pacis was recognized as one of the initiators of the MMSU–Toyota partnership.

Source

• MMSU News, “MMSU ties up with Toyota and DENR for coastal preservation in Pasuquin town,” 4 December 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-ties-up-with-toyota-and-denr-for-coastal-preservation-in-pasuquin-town

• The Manila Times, “TMP Foundation adopts mangrove forest for climate mitigation,” 10 December 2025. https://www.manilatimes.net/2025/12/10/tmt-newswire/tmp-foundation-adopts-mangrove-forest-for-climate-mitigation/2239598

MMSU, Rotary Club and Badoc LGU Restore a Typhoon-Damaged Mangrove Stand



MMSU, Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine and LGU-Badoc plant mangrove propagules in Brgy. Pagsanahan, Badoc, 6 December 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Participants of the mangrove enhancement and growing activity in Badoc, 6 December 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

On December 6, 2025, Mariano Marcos State University, the Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine and the Local Government Unit of Badoc planted 280 mangrove propagules in Barangay Pagsanahan, Badoc, Ilocos Norte, to restore a mangrove stand extensively damaged by past typhoons and to ensure the continuity of ecological succession at the site.

The activity was led by MMSU President Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., with the LGU of Badoc headed by Hon. Virgilio M. Calajate and the Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine under Atty. Zsa Zsa Raval. MMSU's Vice President for Resource Generation and its Directors for Extension, Curriculum Development and Innovative Learning, and Student Affairs and Development also took part.

Source

• MMSU News, "MMSU ties up with Rotary Club of Laoag Sunshine for mangrove planting in Badoc town," 11 December 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-ties-up-with-rotary-club-of-laoag-sunshine-for-mangrove-planting-in-badoc-town

MMSU Plants 250 Mangrove Propagules in Currimao on World Environment Day



Mangrove planting for World Environment Day, Brgy. Maglaoi, Currimao, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)



MMSU, LGU Currimao, DENR and fisherfolk volunteers at the planting site, June 2025. (Photo: MMSU STRATCOM)

In June 2025, in celebration of World Environment Day, Mariano Marcos State University planted 250 mangrove propagules along the coastal area of Barangay Maglaoi, Currimao, Ilocos Norte, to restore degraded shorelines, enhance climate resilience and promote sustainable coastal resource management. The activity was spearheaded by the MMSU Sustainability and Futures Thinking (SFT) Office with the Local Government Unit of Currimao and led by Dr. Mee Jay Domingo, Vice President for Planning and Strategic Foresight.

MMSU faculty, education support personnel and students joined representatives of the Department of Environment and Natural Resources, barangay officials, members of local fisherfolk organizations and community members. SFT Director Dr. Arlene Gonzales explained that mangroves were chosen because they act as natural filters that intercept plastic waste from land before it reaches the sea, while absorbing carbon, protecting shorelines from erosion and providing habitat for marine life.

Source

• MMSU News, "MMSU plants 250 mangrove propagules in Currimao," 11 June 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-plants-250-mangrove-propagules-in-currimao

MMSU and DENR Region 1 Strengthen Partnership for Mangrove Conservation



Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales at the MMSU–DENR Region 1 dialogue on mangrove conservation, ILAARRDEC.



MMSU and DENR Region 1 officials during the dialogue at ILAARRDEC.

MMSU, in partnership with the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) Region 1, convened a dialogue at ILAARRDEC to advance mangrove conservation and coastal resilience in the Ilocos Region through science-based and community-centered approaches. Central to the dialogue was the DOST-PCAARRD-funded nature-based solutions mangrove project led by Dr. Arlene Gonzales.

DENR officials pledged technical support and active participation in restoration, monitoring and evaluation activities. The same project brought representatives of Currimao, Pasuquin, Badoc and Burgos, with DENR-PENRO, to MMSU's mangrove propagation seminar-workshop on October 27–28, 2025.

Source

• MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking

• MMSU News, "MMSU trains Ilocos Norte coastal towns on mangrove propagation and management," 5 November 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2670/mmsu-trains-ilocos-norte-coastal-towns-on-mangrove-propagation-and-management

Indigenous Food Plant Foodscapes Established with Vintar and San Nicolas Partners



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

In October 2025, the MMSU Extension and Research Directorates partnered with local government units and schools to establish Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks for Indigenous Food Plants. Held at Eladio V. Barangan Memorial Elementary School in San Nicolas, Ilocos Norte, the activity brought together officials of Barangays San Roque and Parut, Vintar, the Municipal Agriculture Office of Vintar, agricultural extension workers, school leaders and community representatives as the second batch of partner sites.

The partner communities maintain the foodscapes as shared seedbanks and learning gardens, with planting materials and technical assistance from MMSU, to conserve indigenous food resources such as kapaskapas, alokon, pako, dalayap, wild singkamas and roselle. They join existing foodscape sites in Sarrat and Batac.

Source

• MMSU Extension Directorate, "MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs," October 2025. https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus

• MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking

A New Bambusetum in Barangay Aglipay, Pinili



Participants of the bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training, Brgy. Aglipay, Pinili, 2025. (Photo: MMSU)

During a two-day bamboo production training in 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate and CAFSD, with Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, and the support of ILAARRDEC, worked with 46 farmers, local leaders and community members to establish a new

bambusetum, a collection of bamboo species, in Barangay Aglipay. The training covered bamboo propagation, nursery establishment and plantation management.

Source

• MMSU News, “Sustainable livelihood: MMSU, ILAARRDEC hold bamboo training in Pinili,” 3 September 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/sustainable-livelihood-mmsu-ilaarrdec-hold-bamboo-training-in-pinili

Mangrove Nature-based Solutions Project Runs from 2024 to 2026

Project term 1 May 2024 to 30 April 2026, which covers the data year.



Project Leader Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales presents the project at its launch, MMSU Review Center, 27 June 2024. (Image credit: TTPD, DOST-PCAARRD)



The MMSU project team with DOST-PCAARRD, DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte and the LGUs of Badoc and Currimao at the launch. (Image credit: TTPD, DOST-PCAARRD)

The DOST-PCAARRD-funded project “Nature-based Solutions (NbS) for Sustainable Mangrove Management and Resilient Coastal Communities Through Innovative Green Engineering Approach,” led by Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU, was launched at the MMSU Review Center on June 27, 2024, and runs from May 1, 2024 to April 30, 2026 in Badoc and Currimao, Ilocos Norte. DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte and the local government units of Badoc and Currimao support the project.

The project addresses the poor hydrological conditions that keep young mangrove propagules from surviving, using technology-assisted plantations and locally available, ecologically friendly materials, including bamboo-engineered structures that protect young mangroves and improve their survival.

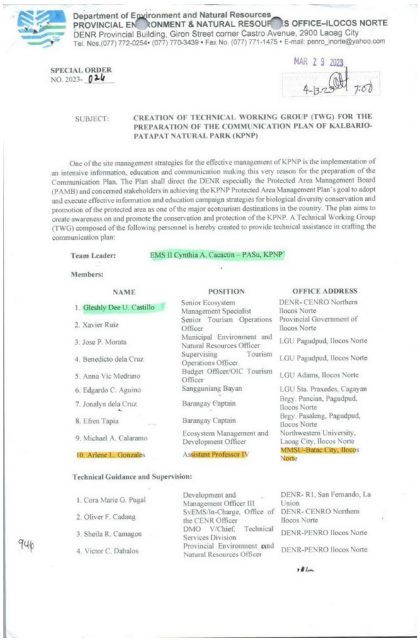
The 2025 activities of the project, including the dialogue with DENR Region 1 and the October 2025 mangrove propagation seminar-workshop, are described under Indicators 15.2.3 and 15.2.4.

Source

• DOST-PCAARRD, “DOST-PCAARRD, MMSU launch nature-based solutions project on mangrove management in Ilocos Norte,” 7 August 2024. https://www.pcaarrd.dost.gov.ph/index.php/quick-information-dispatch-qid-articles/dost-pcaarrd-mmsu-launch-nature-based-solutions-project-on-mangrove-management-in-ilocos-norte

MMSU Expert Serves on the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park Technical Working Group

Appointment of 29 March 2023, still in effect as far as the records show.



Department of Environment and Natural Resources
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SPECIAL ORDER
NO. 2023- 024

MAR 29 2023

SUBJECT: CREATION OF TECHNICAL WORKING GROUP (TWG) FOR THE PREPARATION OF THE COMMUNICATION PLAN OF KALBARIO-PATAPAT NATURAL PARK (KPNP)

One of the site management strategies for the effective management of KPNP is the implementation of an intensive information, education and communication making this very reason for the preparation of the Communication Plan. The Plan shall direct the DENR especially the Protected Area Management Board (PAMB) and concerned stakeholders in achieving the KPNP Protected Area Management Plan's goal to adopt and execute effective information and education campaign strategies for biological diversity conservation and promotion of the protected area as one of the major ecotourism destinations in the country. The plan aims to create awareness on and promote the conservation and protection of the KPNP. A Technical Working Group (TWG) composed of the following personnel is hereby created to provide technical assistance in crafting the communication plan:

Team Leader: EMS II Cynthia A. Cacactin – PASu, KPNP

Members:

NAME	POSITION	OFFICE ADDRESS
1. Gleshly Dee U. Castillo	Senior Ecosystem Management Specialist	DENR- CENRO Northern Ilocos Norte
2. Xavier Ruiz	Senior Tourism Operations Officer	Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte
3. Jose P. Morata	Municipal Environment and Natural Resources Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
4. Benedicto dela Cruz	Supervising Tourism Operations Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
5. Anna Vic Madriano	Budget Officer/OIC Tourism Officer	LGU Adams, Ilocos Norte
6. Edgardo C. Aguino	Sangguniang Bayan	LGU Sta. Praxedes, Cagayan
7. Jonalyn dela Cruz	Barangay Captain	Brgy. Pancian, Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
8. Efren Tapia	Barangay Captain	Brgy. Pasaleng, Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
9. Michael A. Calaramo	Ecosystem Management and Development Officer	Northwestern University, Laoag City, Ilocos Norte
10. Arlene L. Gonzales	Assistant Professor IV	MMSU-Batac City, Ilocos Norte

Technical Guidance and Supervision:

1. Cora Marie G. Pagal	Development and Management Officer III	DENR- R1, San Fernando, La Union
2. Oliver F. Cadang	SvEMS/In-Charge, Office of the CENR Officer	DENR- CENRO Northern Ilocos Norte
3. Sheila R. Camagon	DMO V/Chief, Technical Services Division	DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte
4. Victor C. Dabalos	Provincial Environment and Natural Resources Officer	DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte

Document: DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024 (29 March 2023) naming Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU to the KPNP Technical Working Group.

Through DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, dated March 29, 2023, Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU was named a member of the Technical Working Group that prepares the Communication Plan of the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park (KPNP), a protected area in Ilocos Norte. The group, led by the KPNP Protected Area Superintendent, brings together DENR offices, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, the LGUs of Pagudpud and Adams in Ilocos Norte and Sta. Praxedes in Cagayan, barangay officials and Northwestern University.

The Communication Plan supports the goal of the KPNP Protected Area Management Plan to adopt and carry out effective information and education campaigns for biological diversity conservation and for the promotion of the protected area as a major ecotourism destination.

Source

• DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, 29 March 2023 (MMSU SDG 15 page). https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1TCpM-DxbkgfOh4QGwlfVr8QavCchKWKu/data

Only the submission pick is entered in the portal. The other items are internal evidence.

5 · Before submission

☐	The indicator on page 2 has a submission pick or a note that no evidence was found
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Open items for this indicator

☐ Attach a copy of the signed Pasuquin memorandum of agreement (29 Nov 2025).
☐ Confirm the date of the 2025 MMSU–DENR Region 1 dialogue at ILAARRDEC.

☐ Mangrove NbS project term ended 30 Apr 2026; the Kalbario-Patapat appointment dates from 2023. Both are continuing evidence.